Jiwei Zhou

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EDUCATION

Purdue University, West Lafayette, IN **May 2023**
Ph.D. in Technology GPA: 3.98/4.0

Shanghai Jiao Tong University, Shanghai, China **June 2016**
M.Eng. in Software Engineering

Zhuhai College of Jilin University (now Zhuhai College of Science and Technology), Guangdong, China **July 2012**
B.E. in Mechanical Design & Manufacture and Automation

JOURNAL PUBLICATIONS

J7. Gupta, D., Camba, J. D., Fuerst, T., **Zhou, J.** (2026). From Queries to Conversations: Exploring AI-Based Virtual Assistant Adoption, Usability, and Impact in Engineering Education. *ASEE Computers in Education*, *15*(4). https://doi.org/10.18260/B4D7-9A-19836

J6. **Zhou, J.**, Camba, J. D., Company, P. (2026). CADialogue: A Multimodal LLM-Powered Conversational Assistant for Intuitive Parametric CAD Modeling. *Computer-Aided Design*, *191*, 104006. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cad.2025.104006

J5. **Zhou, J.**, & Camba, J. D. (2025). The status, evolution, and future challenges of multimodal large language models (LLMs) in parametric CAD. *Expert Systems with Applications*, *282*, 127520. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.eswa.2025.127520

J4. **Zhou, J.**, Camba, J. D., Li, X. (2025). An Approach to Drawing Automation of Ship Stiffeners in the Shipbuilding Industry. *Computer-Aided Design and Applications*, *22*(1), 26-41. https://doi.org/10.14733/cadaps.2025.25-41

J3. **Zhou, J.**, & Hartman, N. W. (2024). A Model-Based Visual Inspection System (MBVIS) for Critical Plastic Bottle Dimensional Measurements. *Computer-Aided Design and Applications*, *21*(2), 270-280. https://doi.org/10.14733/cadaps.2024.270-280

J2. **Zhou, J.**, & Hartman, N. W. (2024). Development and Evaluation of a Vision Inspection System for Plastic Bottle Measurement. *Advances in Science and Technology*, *149*, 41-50. https://doi.org/10.4028/p-HPT9vc

J1. **Zhou, J.**, & Camba, J. D. (2021). Computer-aided process planning in immersive environments: A critical review. *Computers in Industry*, *133*, 103547. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.compind.2021.103547

PEER-REVIEWED CONFERENCE PROCEEDINGS

C12. **Zhou, J.**, Camba, J. D. *(presented).* EngDraw-Annotator: An AI-Assisted Interactive System for Evidence-Linked Engineering Drawing Annotation. *CIRPe 2026*.

C11. **Zhou, J.**, Camba, J. D. *(accepted)*. MAS-DFM: A Traceable Multi-Agent Framework for Drawing-Based Manufacturability Analysis. *2026 8th International Conference on Industry of the Future and Smart Manufacturing (ISM)*.

C10. **Zhou, J.**, & Camba, J. D. *(presented)*. EngDraw-Extractor: A Multi-Agent System for Information Extraction from 2D Engineering Drawings. *International Design Engineering Technical Conferences & Computers and Information in Engineering Conference (IDETC-CIE 2026)*.

C9. Camba, J. D., Contero, M., and **Zhou, J.** *(presented)*. Large Language Models in Digital Manufacturing: An Empirical Study of Verification-Centered Design Cognition. *12th International Conference on Design Computing and Cognition (DCC'26)*.

C8. **Zhou, J.**, Camba, J. D., Company, P., Contero, M. *(presented)*. EngDraw-VQA: An Agent-Based Framework for Automated Visual Question Answering Generation From Engineering Drawings. *Manufacturing Science and Engineering Conference (MSEC 2026)*.

C7. **Zhou, J.**, Camba, J. D., Company, P., Contero, M. Drawing-Checker: A Vision RAG Framework for Automated Comparison of Engineering Drawings. *Procedia CIRP*, *142*, 127-132. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.procir.2026.05.235

C6. Company, P., Camba, J. D., Contero, M., **Zhou, J.** (2026). From conceptual to embodiment design using Sketch-Based Modeling and Feature Recognition Techniques. *23rd annual International CAD Conference (CAD'26)*, https://doi.org/10.14733/cadconfP.2026.50-54

C5. **Zhou, J.**, Gupta, D., & Camba, J. D. (2026). Prompt2CAD: A Lightweight LLM Framework for Conversational CAD Generation and Iterative Refinement. *Procedia Computer Science*, *277*, 1663-1672. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.procs.2026.02.204

C4. Gupta, D., Camba, J. D., Fuerst, T., & **Zhou, J.** (2025). WIP: An AI-Based Virtual Assistant for Supporting a Large Engineering Course. *IEEE Frontiers in Education Conference (FIE 2025)*, https://doi.org/10.1109/FIE63693.2025.11328408

C3. **Zhou, J.**, & Hartman, N. W. (2023). A Framework for Model-Based Visual Inspection: A Case Study of Bottle Dimensional Measurements in the Plastics Industry. *2023 CAD Conference and Exposition*, 74-79. https://doi.org/10.14733/cadconfP.2023.74-79

C2. **Zhou, J.**, Camba, J. D., Hartman, N. W., & Li, Z. (2022). An Approach to Extend the Digital Thread From Requirements to Model Geometry. *Manufacturing Science and Engineering Conference (MSEC) 2022*. https://doi.org/10.1115/MSEC2022-80857

C1. **Zhou, J.**, Camba, J. D., & Fuerst, T. (2022). A Comparative Study on the Use and Interpretation of Annotated 3D Models. *IFIP 18th International Conference on Product Lifecycle Management*. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-030-94399-8_23

- 🏆 *Best Paper Award Nominee*

MANUSCRIPTS

M3. **Zhou, J.**, Camba, J. D. *(under review)*. Human–AI Co-Design from Visual Requirements to Physical Validation: A Parametric Hydroponic Adapter Case Study.

M2. **Zhou, J.**, Camba, J. D., Company, P. *(submitted)*. CADThread: A Multimodal Engineering Design Dataset Linking Feature-Based Parametric CAD, Geometry, and Drawings.

M1. Camba, J. D., **Zhou, J.** GenAI-Aided Design in Engineering Education: Competencies, Challenges, and Opportunities (Anticipated submission: 2026).

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

P9. *EngDraw-Annotator: An AI-Assisted Interactive System for Evidence-Linked Engineering Drawing Annotation*. Remote presentation, **14th CIRP Global Web Conference (CIRPe 2026)**, hosted by Nanyang Technological University, Singapore.

P8. *EngDraw-Extractor: A Multi-Agent System for Information Extraction from 2D Engineering Drawings*. Oral presentation, **ASME 2026 International Design Engineering Technical Conferences and Computers and Information in Engineering Conference (IDETC-CIE 2026)**, Houston, Texas, USA.

P7. *EngDraw-VQA: An Agent-Based Framework for Automated Visual Question Answering Generation from Engineering Drawings*. Oral presentation, **ASME 2026 International Manufacturing Science & Engineering Conference (MSEC 2026)**, hosted by Penn State University, State College, Pennsylvania, USA.

P6. *Prompt2CAD: A Lightweight LLM Framework for Conversational CAD Generation and Iterative Refinement*. Remote presentation, **7th International Conference on Industry of the Future and Smart Manufacturing (ISM 2025)**, hosted by the University of Malta, Valletta Campus, Valletta, Malta.

P5. *Integrating Artificial Intelligence in Plant Growth Monitoring for Innovative Rotary Aeroponic Systems*. Oral presentation, **2025 North American Plant Phenotyping Network Annual Conference (NAPPN 2025)**, hosted by the Donald Danforth Plant Science Center, Olivette, Missouri, USA.

P4. *Development and Evaluation of a Vision Inspection System for Plastic Bottle Measurement*. Remote presentation, **10th International Conference on Mechanics, Materials and Manufacturing (ICMMM 2023)**, Washington, D.C., USA.

P3. *A Framework for Model-Based Visual Inspection: A Case Study of Bottle Dimensional Measurements in the Plastics Industry*. Remote presentation, **20th International CAD Conference (CAD'23)**, Mexico City, Mexico.

P2. *An Approach to Extend the Digital Thread from Requirements to Model Geometry*. Oral presentation, **ASME 2022 International Manufacturing Science & Engineering Conference (MSEC 2022)**, hosted by Purdue University, West Lafayette, Indiana, USA.

P1. *A Comparative Study on the Use and Interpretation of Annotated 3D Models*. Remote presentation, **IFIP 18th International Conference on Product Lifecycle Management (PLM 2021)**, virtual conference.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Heliponix LLC, Evansville, IN **June 2023 – Present**
Computer Vision Scientist

- Conduct interdisciplinary research in applied AI to drive innovation in engineering design, smart manufacturing, and technology education.
- Lead the deployment of AI-powered vision systems in IoT-enabled smart appliances, enabling real-time crop monitoring and autonomous decision-making.
- Collaborate across hardware and software teams to design cyber-physical prototypes, integrating imaging sensors, edge AI, and cloud-based analytics for scalable smart gardening and precision agriculture solutions.
- Develop and optimize machine learning and deep learning algorithms, influencing the design of computer vision hardware and software.
- Develop research proposals to secure external funding for research and development.

Digital Enterprise Center, Purdue University, West Lafayette, IN **August 2019 – May 2023**
Graduate Research Assistant

Drug Plastics - Model-based Metrology Project September 2021 – May 2023

- Developed an innovative and cost-effective Model-Based Visual Inspection System (MBVIS) to enhance the critical dimensional measurement accuracy of plastic bottles in pharmaceutical applications, utilizing Geometric Dimensioning and Tolerancing (GD&T) information extracted from a Model-Based Definition (MBD) dataset, demonstrating high agreement with a commercial visual inspection system through Bland-Altman plot analysis
- Utilized Computer Vision techniques (OpenCV-Python and convolutional neural networks) to develop a more efficient process to measure critical bottle parameters

WHIN - Digital Product Information Project August 2020 – August 2021

- Implemented RESTful APIs to facilitate interactive work instructions and Bill of Material (BOM) on a Product Data Management (PDM) system with Java
- Customized tooling management, process planning, workflow, project, and organizational structure on the PDM system to demonstrate to industrial partners

Siemens Industry Software, Shanghai, China **July 2012 – July 2019**
Application Engineer

- Led testing and development of CAD software (Siemens NX), improving product reliability and reducing customer-reported issues by 15%.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to design and automate test workflows, achieving >95% code coverage and improved development efficiency.
- Supported partner universities through Siemens GO PLM initiatives, delivering CAD training and fostering academic–industry collaboration.
- Mentored junior engineers and coordinated quality assurance processes across multiple international projects.

Siemens Industry Software, Shanghai, China **July 2011 – July 2012**
NX Ship QA Intern

- Tested on NX Ship Manufacture Module to improve ship product quality
- Created more than 300 reuse CAD parts to support NX Drawing Automation in the shipbuilding industry

FUNDING & GRANTS

- **National Science Foundation (NSF) SBIR Phase II (Award No. 2151495)**—Partial support for research activities at Heliponix LLC
- **Project PID2022-137254OB-I00 (MCIN/AEI/FEDER, EU)**—Research support for peer-reviewed publications at Heliponix LLC
- **Wabash Heartland Innovation Network (Grant No. 4019008000 / 8000084103)**—Research support at Purdue University
- **USDA NIFA SBIR (proposal in preparation)**—Proposed Principal Investigator (PI), Heliponix LLC.

PUBLIC SPEAKING & OUTREACH

Southwest Ecosystem Exchange
Evansville, IN **June 2025**

- Represented the company at the inaugural Southwest Ecosystem Exchange, sharing our startup journey and key support resources leveraged—including SBIR/STTR, match funding, and local partnerships—to inspire and connect with regional innovation leaders.

Generative AI and Programming-Based CAD
Purdue University, West Lafayette, IN **Apr 2025**

- Delivered a 120-minute guest lecture covering programming-based CAD techniques, aligning with current research in Generative AI-enhanced design automation. Engaged graduate students through practical examples, interactive discussion, and Q&A.

2025 CCO International Student Workshop – Internationally Friendly Employer Panel
Purdue University, West Lafayette, IN **Mar 2025**

- Served as a panelist sharing insights on transitioning from international graduate studies to careers in the U.S. tech industry, emphasizing the role of AI and computer vision in practical applications.

Leveraging Artificial Intelligence for a Competitive Edge in Business
Indiana University, Bloomington, IN **Jan 2025**

- Delivered a keynote address on how businesses can leverage artificial intelligence for competitive advantage, highlighting opportunities, challenges, and strategies for adoption.

Growing Smarter: How AI Helps Plants Thrive
University of Evansville, Evansville, IN **Jan 2025**

- Delivered a presentation on the role of artificial intelligence in enhancing plant growth and agriculture to inspire the next generation of innovators of the UE Explorers program.

Journey from Academia to Industry

Purdue University in Indianapolis, Indianapolis, IN **Nov 2024**

- Presented a 30-minute talk to college and graduate students on transitioning from academia to industry, covering skill development, challenges, and career growth.

Seeing with Smarts: How AI Helps Plants Grow!

Heliponix LLC, Evansville, IN **Nov 2024**

- Conducted an interactive session introducing core concepts of artificial intelligence and computer vision to middle and high school students, engaging them with practical applications in industry.

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Technical Program Committee

- International Conference on Mechanics, Materials and Manufacturing (ICMMM), 2026

Session Chair

- ASME International Manufacturing Science and Engineering Conference (MSEC), 2026
- International Conference on Mechanics, Materials and Manufacturing (ICMMM), 2023

Conference Reviewer

- ASEE Annual Conference & Exposition, 2023, 2024, 2026, 2027
- ASME International Manufacturing Science and Engineering Conference (MSEC), 2026
- ASME International Mechanical Engineering Congress and Exposition (IMECE), 2026
- IEEE Frontiers in Education Conference (FIE), 2025, 2026
- IEEE Visualization and Visual Analytics (VIS), 2026
- Institute of Industrial and Systems Engineers (IISE) Annual Conference & Expo, 2026
- International Conference on Industry of the Future and Smart Manufacturing (ISM), 2026

Journal Reviewer

- *Applied Soft Computing*
- *Artificial Intelligence and Applications*
- *ASEE Computers in Education*
- *Computer-Aided Design*
- *Computers & Graphics*
- *Computers & Industrial Engineering*
- *Computers in Human Behavior: Artificial Humans*
- *Design Studies*
- *Displays*
- *Engineering Applications of Artificial Intelligence*
- *Engineering with Computers*
- *Expert Systems with Applications*
- *Frontiers in Mechanical Engineering*
- *IEEE Transactions on Computational Social Systems*
- *Image and Vision Computing*
- *International Journal of Information Management Data Insights*
- *Journal of Industrial Information Integration*
- *Results in Engineering*
- *SoftwareX*
- *Transactions on Graphics*

CERTIFICATION & TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Siemens Certified NX CAD Instructor **September 2011**

Siemens Teamcenter Instructor, PLM Product Development Center (PPDC), Shanghai, China **July 2013 – July 2019**

- Offered formal training in CAD skills and Teamcenter application to new employees

AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

Conference Attendance Award **Feb 2025**

- NAPPN Conference 2025 Supported by USDA NIFA DSFAS Program

Purdue Graduate Research Assistantship **August 2019 – May 2023**

High-Performance Employee Awarded by Siemens PLM Software **2014 & 2016**

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Heliponix LLC, Evansville, IN **June 2023 – Present**

Research Associate Supervisor

- Supervised a research associate, providing technical guidance and overseeing weekly progress on tasks related to plant science and computer vision

Christian Students at Purdue (CSaP), Purdue University, West Lafayette, IN **January 2020 – May 2023**

Vice President

- Supervised the business of the organization and organized a weekly Bible study for club members

Siemens Industry Software, Shanghai, China **July 2012 – July 2019**

Mentor

- Guided junior engineers and interns with professional CAD modeling and PLM application knowledge

MEDIA COVERAGE

- *Southwest Ecosystem Exchange (2025).* Presentation on Anu's startup journey and ESO partnerships. [Link]
- *Purdue University Center for Career Opportunities & Office of Professional Practice (2024).* Invited panelist on international student career planning and transitions into U.S. industry roles. [Link]
- *Indiana University Kelley School of Business (2024).* Invited keynote speaker for MBA consulting project on Food as Medicine, presenting Anu's AI-driven indoor farming approach to health and sustainability. [Link]
- *Purdue University (2022).* Poster presentation on Realizing the Digital Enterprise projects, highlighted in university media coverage. [Link]